

Robert Wade

Spring Hill, TN (Greater Nashville)

+1 (314) 630-5428

bob@bobwa.de

linkedin.com/in/bwade231

github.com/bwade

bobwa.de

ENGINEERING LEADER · PLATFORM & RELIABILITY ·
PARTNER & PRODUCT · AI-AUGMENTED OPS

\$100B+ COMMERCE MOVED	99.99% UPTIME, SUSTAINED	130M+ AMAZON CLICKS A MONTH	13 / 2 ENGINEERS, FUNCTIONS OWNED
---------------------------	-----------------------------	--------------------------------	--------------------------------------

EXPERTISE

LEADERSHIP

Multi-function org design · Multi-team Agile ceremonies · Hiring and bar setting · Coaching and career development · Performance management · PERM sponsorship · Exec and VP reporting

PLATFORM RELIABILITY

Incident command · On-call and PagerDuty · Blameless postmortems · SLAs · Observability · Peak load readiness

PARTNER ENGINEERING

Enterprise integrations · Escalation management · Attribution and event pipelines · Retail media

PRODUCT AND DELIVERY

Roadmapping and release planning · Backlog and capacity planning · Feasibility and scoping gates · Cross-functional delivery across product, revenue, and support

DESIGN AND UX

Brand and logo design · UI/UX · Figma · Front-end build

AI AND AUTOMATION

Claude and MCP · Custom MCP servers · Agentic PRD to ticket pipelines · Generative creative

STACK

BACKEND AND DATA

Go · Python · Node.js · Postgres · Aurora · MongoDB · BigQuery

FRONTEND

TypeScript · React · Next.js · Tailwind

CLOUD AND INFRASTRUCTURE

AWS (ECS, EC2, RDS/Aurora, S3, SES, Route 53) · GCP · Terraform · Docker · GitHub Actions

PROFILE

Senior Engineering Manager at Button leading two engineering functions through managers as well as ICs: Core Engineering and Solutions Engineering, 13 engineers, and the platform behind \$100B+ in mobile commerce for Amazon, Walmart, Uber, Lyft, Fetch, and Sam's Club. 19 years in engineering, 10+ in management, and 25 engineers across seven teams before that at Centene. I own the platform other teams depend on and keep it dependable: on-call held at 99.99% uptime and core engineering interrupts cut by routing support triage away from the team. Delivery now runs on AI-augmented workflows, with about 45% of shipped code AI written and engineer reviewed. Also act as product owner for my org, holding the roadmap, backlog, and the call on what gets built.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineering Manager, Core Engineering & Solutions Engineering

Button, Inc. · Oct 2021 - Present · Remote (NYC)

Own two engineering functions and 13 direct reports: Core Engineering (routing, attribution, data, infrastructure) and Solutions Engineering (partner delivery and technical escalation), covering the platform behind \$100B+ in driven mobile commerce and routing 130M+ Amazon creator clicks a month across 200+ brands including Amazon, Walmart, Uber, Lyft, Fetch, Target, and Sam's Club. I own both the platform and the partner handoff that most orgs split and drop.

RELIABILITY AND HIGH-TRAFFIC EVENTS

- My team owns the **core infrastructure that makes Button run**: the routing, decisioning, attribution, and order pipeline every partner and dollar flows through. I hold the **RTB/KTLO mandate** for it, covering reliability, tech debt, and operational load for systems moving \$100B+ in commerce.
- Lead **Amazon Prime Day readiness** year over year, Button's largest revenue event: traffic modeling, load testing, and Go/No-Go across the core services. Planned and load-tested the jump from an **80 RPS baseline to a 1,200 RPS peak**, with no downtime across the event window.
- Own on-call and incident response for the core platform, **sustaining 99.99% uptime** and cutting MTTR across severity, escalation, and blameless postmortems.
- **Cut core engineering interrupts** by standing up a Support→Data→Core escalation flow: first-level triage in Zendesk, the data team absorbing impact analysis, and self-serve tooling for the most common partner questions. Reactive firefighting became protected delivery capacity.

SCALE, PLATFORM MODERNIZATION, AND AI-AUGMENTED OPERATIONS

- Own Button's **order pipeline, the platform's revenue path** at 600K+ orders a day. Drove autoscaling, **Aurora migrations**, and modernization of the partnership configuration service, and led the **release-confidence program** (staging parity plus end-to-end testing) behind it. Backed the right-sizing that took the link-generation service from 400 instances to 15 and the click-redirect service from 400 to 130, cutting CPU per task from 80% to 25% and peak-event scaling cost from roughly \$20K a month to about \$7.5K.
- Championed AI-augmented delivery. Org-wide, Claude-attributed code reached **about 45% of lines shipped**.
- Sponsored internal **read-only LLM tooling**, a Sam's Club order debugger and a CSV validator, that cut manual triage load. Built with tightly scoped tools to prevent hallucination.

SUPPORT ENGINEERING AND SERVICE DESIGN

- There was **no partner-support function at Button before me**. I made the case to leadership, secured the budget and tooling, and led the engineer who built it, taking support from **100% ad hoc** (Slack DMs and email, no ownership or routing) to a structured, SLA-backed operation.
- Set the direction for the **Salesforce→Zendesk→Jira** model and steered the engineer who designed it, with Zendesk as the source of truth for routing, prioritization, and SLAs. **Formed the Support Engineering team** that owns it.
- Defined **tiered SLAs** and the incident priority matrix across strategic partners (Uber, Amazon, Best Buy, Sam's Club, Fetch): **P0 acknowledged in under 15 minutes**, 30-minute response for Tier 1, plus the escalation decision tree routing work across Solutions Engineering, Data, and on-call.

PARTNER INTEGRATIONS, PRODUCT, AND REVENUE

- Solutions Engineering landed and scaled integrations across a who's-who of commerce, travel, and marketplace: **Amazon, Walmart, Best Buy, Target, Sam's Club, Nike, Lululemon, Puma, Samsung, Expedia, Marriott, Uber One, Lyft, Disney+, and StubHub**, including a full platform migration for Sam's Club.
- **Standardized the enterprise integration path** and removed bespoke per partner engineering, so a new partner lands on a repeatable process instead of a custom build.
- Led formation and initial delivery of Button's **retail media product**: set the roadmap and release plan with product and revenue, and shipped initial releases with NY Post, Forbes, and BuzzFeed.

ORGANIZATION AND DELIVERY LEADERSHIP

- Inherited Core Engineering when my manager left, **built Solutions Engineering from scratch**, and hired into both. I **lead through managers, not only ICs**: a Solutions Engineering leader on the director track reports to me directly. Raised the hiring bar, authored the career-growth ladder and design-review process, and sponsored a PERM labor certification end to end.
- Early on, led engineering for **the creator link product** and ran half the org through the post-COVID rebuild.
- Act as **engineering manager, product manager, and scrum lead** for my org: own the roadmap, backlog prioritization, quarterly capacity planning, and every Agile ceremony across multiple squads on two week sprints, plus the feasibility gate between Revenue, Product, and Engineering on what actually gets built.

Founder & Principal

Digital Tide • Mar 2025 - Present • Remote

Independent consultancy where I found and run businesses end to end, wearing every hat: product, engineering, business, growth, and design. I stand companies up (entity, cloud, email, go to market), build the apps, and take on brand and design work where it is mine to do. Selected engagements are listed below.

- **Sanbar (sanbar.us)**: built the client's entire technical foundation, covering GCP and AWS infrastructure, DNS, email and identity, the deployment pipeline, and the production site.
- **That Paleo Chick (thatpaleochick.com)**: built the business, not just the site. AWS infrastructure, transactional and marketing email, social content produced and scheduled automatically through Postiz, and affiliate monetization, running as a near fully automated operation.
- **Greedy**: ran the full site redesign end to end, from scope through vendors to launch, and own social and paid acquisition, including a competitive playbook built from live Meta Ad Library teardowns and AI generated video creative.
- **Charter**: designed and built an invoicing application solo, covering auth, billing entities, invoice generation, and payment tracking.
- **Design and brand**: designed the brand and logo for Digital Tide and That Paleo Chick, plus the UI and UX for the apps I have shipped.
- **Digital Tide (digitalti.de)**: the same playbook applied to my own firm, plus the standards clients inherit, meaning Linear first delivery, GitHub Actions CI, and Slack automation.

IT Manager, Engineering Chapter

Centene Corporation • Jan 2019 - Oct 2021 • St. Louis, MO

- Led **25 engineers across seven cross functional Agile teams** delivering member facing web and mobile applications and new health plan implementations.
- Built the standard engineering process layer for all web and mobile matrix teams, and defined the metrics leadership used for staffing and prioritization.
- Created a **Developer Assessment Framework** that made role expectations explicit. Top 10% employee engagement across web leadership teams.

IT Manager, Member AI & Mobile, then Senior Application Software Engineer

Centene Corporation • Sep 2014 - Jan 2019 • St. Louis, MO

- Built and led the cross functional team that shipped a **self service AI health assistant**, reducing call center volume, and established the SDLC framework for the inherited application.
- Delivered **more than 20 mobile applications** across iOS and Android, launched care management in the Florida market, and standardized mobile build, release, and compliance for state contracts.
- As Senior Engineer: shipped OAuth 2.0 via API Gateway, migrated the org from SVN to Git, and mentored about 10 engineers.

EDUCATION

A.A.S., Multimedia & Web Design
St. Charles Community College • 2004 - 2007

CERTIFICATIONS

ITIL Foundation
AXELOS

Leadership Development Program
Centene

EARLIER

Software Engineer / Web Producer
Centene • 2013 - 2014

Team Lead, Visual Design
N-Depth Solutions • 2008 - 2013

Web Developer
Clear Pages • 2007 - 2008